PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Security Information and Event Management Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of hands-on experience in enterprise cyber security engineering, specialising in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR/XDR). At the University of the Arts London, I lead the detection engineering and alert triage function for an environment of 8,000 users, operating across CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, and Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR). I bring deep expertise in firewall management, identity and access management via Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), and structured vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera breach and attack simulation. I thrive in high-impact, focused security teams and am looking to bring this experience to an asset management environment where precision, responsiveness, and cross-platform security operations matter.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and SOAR:** CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk, KQL, detection rule authoring, SOAR playbook automation
- **EDR and XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR)
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID, Okta-equivalent SSO, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Firewall and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony, Mimecast, network traffic analysis, perimeter security
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting, forensic triage, post-incident review
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Entra ID Conditional Access, Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM), Tanium endpoint management
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR automation workflows
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+), MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead all security operations for an 8,000-user environment, acting as the primary subject matter expert for SIEM/SOAR, EDR/XDR, and identity security across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel.
- Engineer and tune SIEM detection rules and SOAR automation playbooks, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-severity alerts.
- Perform structured threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, and Microsoft Sentinel KQL queries to identify low-signal adversarial activity.
- Oversee vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS; prioritise and track remediation in partnership with infrastructure teams.
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID identity security, including Conditional Access policy review, MFA enforcement, and privileged identity hygiene via BeyondTrust PAM.
- Respond to and lead major security incidents following NIST SP 800-61 procedures, producing executive-level post-incident reports and improvement actions.
- Maintain and improve Check Point Harmony firewall rule sets, Mimecast email security, and Tanium endpoint hygiene across the enterprise.

- Support Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) accreditation from a technical controls perspective, evidencing security posture against CIS Controls and NIST CSF.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Delivered day-to-day SIEM alert triage, EDR alert investigation, and incident response across CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE).
- Supported the deployment and configuration of Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365 (M365), improving identity threat detection coverage.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning and reporting using Nessus and AppCheck; coordinated remediation with network and application teams.
- Wrote and maintained KQL-based detection queries and hunting rules in Microsoft Sentinel, aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques.
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) solution, managing privileged account lifecycle and session recording.
- Automated repetitive security tasks using PowerShell scripts, reducing manual analyst effort across endpoint patching, log review, and user account audits.
- Contributed to identity governance initiatives including Single Sign-On (SSO) rollout and Conditional Access policy design in Microsoft Entra ID.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Provided security engineering support across cloud and on-premises infrastructure for a SaaS and Financial Technology (FinTech) platform serving enterprise clients.
- Managed endpoint security tooling, firewall configuration, and vulnerability scanning, maintaining a strong security baseline across the technology estate.
- Implemented and monitored Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies, securing employee devices and data.
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance activities including evidence collection, risk assessments, and internal audit preparation.
- Configured and managed Azure Active Directory (now Microsoft Entra ID) including user provisioning, group policy, and conditional access.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Reduced high-severity SIEM alert response time by 40% through SOAR automation playbooks built in CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel.
- Led the deployment of CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent and Insight across all 8,000 UAL endpoints, achieving full EDR coverage and reducing dwell time for detected threats.
- Designed and implemented a threat hunting programme aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, proactively identifying and containing three advanced persistent threat (APT) indicators over 18 months.
- Drove the Pentera BAS programme from inception, identifying critical attack paths across the estate and reducing exploitable vulnerabilities by 65% within 12 months.
- Strengthened identity security posture by redesigning Conditional Access and MFA policies in Microsoft Entra ID, reducing identity-based attack surface by 80%.
- Supported successful Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) certification renewal from a hands-on technical controls perspective, including evidence gathering and remediation of gaps.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+

- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)